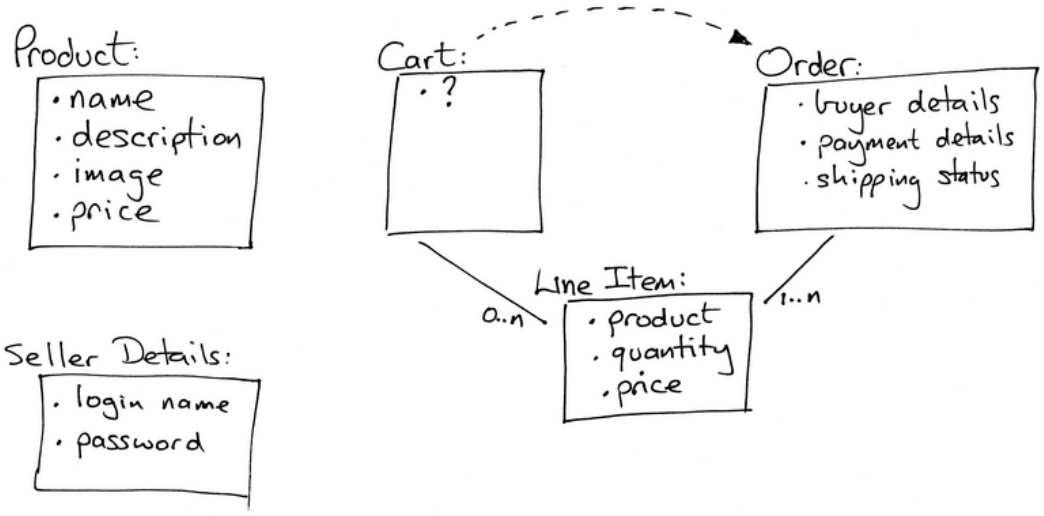
Based on the use cases and the flows, it seems likely that we'll be working with the data shown in the figure. Again, using pencil and paper seems a whole lot easier than some fancy tool, but use whatever works for you.



Working on the data diagram raised a couple of questions. As the user buys items, we'll need somewhere to keep the list of products they bought, so we added a cart. But apart from its use as a transient place to keep this product list, the cart seems to be something of a ghost—we couldn't find anything meaningful to store in it. To reflect this uncertainty, we put a question mark inside the cart's box in the diagram. We're assuming this uncertainty will get resolved as we implement Depot.

Coming up with the high-level data also raised the question of what information should go into an order. Again, we chose to leave this fairly open for now. We'll refine this further as we start showing our early iterations to the customer.

General Recovery Advice

Everything in this book has been tested. If you follow along with this scenario precisely, using the recommended version of Rails and SQLite 3 on Linux, MacOS, or Windows, everything should work as described. However, deviations from this path can occur. Typos happen to the best of us, and not only are side explorations possible, but they're positively encouraged. Be aware that this might lead you to strange places. Don't be afraid: specific